

Implementing Accessibility in a Large Sales and Marketing Platform From Individual Responsibility to Shared Ownership

**A hands-on case study on building shared accessibility
ownership in cross-functional product teams**

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Agenda

01 – About Me

02 – The Platform: A Complex Product Environment

03 – Informal Accessibility Work and Team Setup

04 – Four Steps Towards Shared Ownership

About Me



- **Background in Print and Media Technology**
- **Experience in agencies, product teams, and agile environments**
- **Formerly at Ableton, driving accessibility initiatives for web products**
- **Freelance Web Accessibility Specialist & Web Developer**

The Platform: A Complex Product Environment

- **Product pages and webshop flows**
- **Multiple teams contributing to the platform**
- **Long-established and complex codebase**
- **Accessibility not yet systematically integrated**



Starting Point: Informal Accessibility Work

- **A small web team drove much of the accessibility work**
- **Accessibility was valued, but not yet embedded across the organization**
- **Requests often required informal explanation, review, and follow-up**

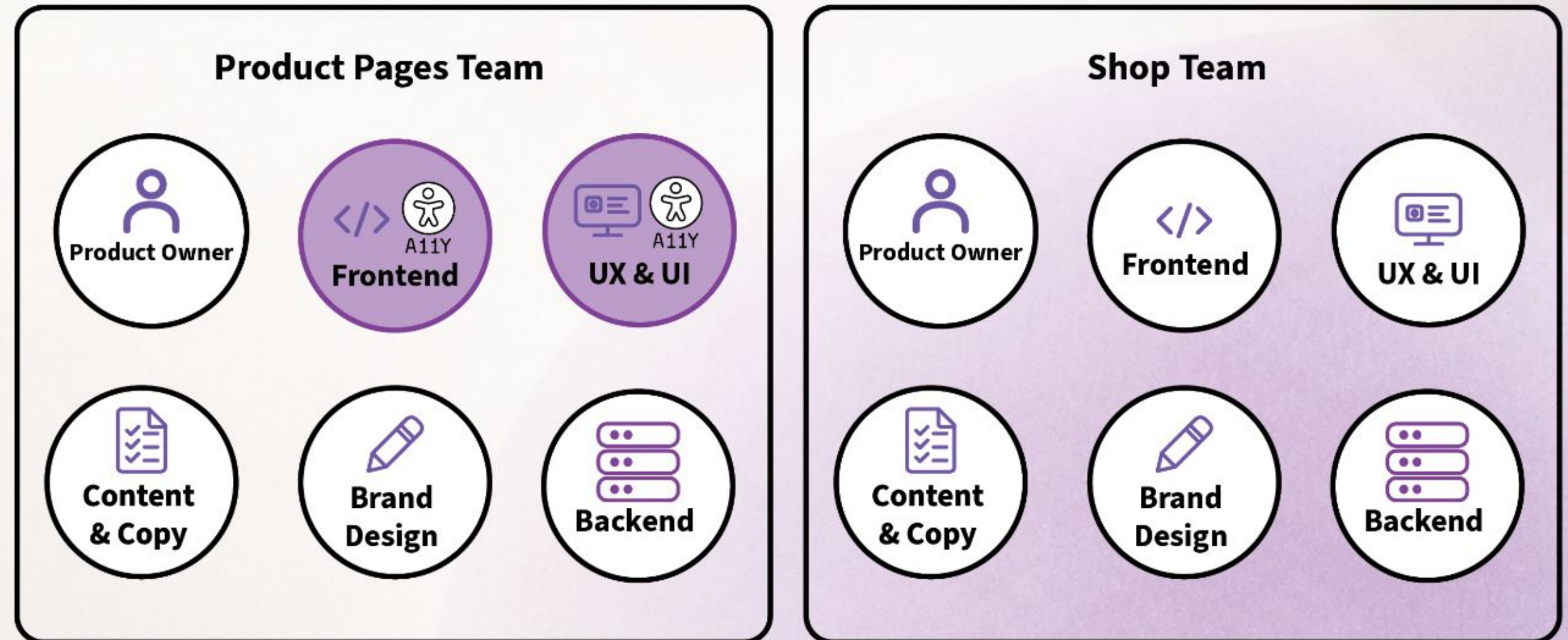


Team Setup: Functional Domains and Cross-Functional Teams

Functional Domains



Cross-Functional Product Teams



Summary: Three Main Challenges

- 1. Accessibility depended too much on individual responsibility**
- 2. No consistent workflow to plan, implement, and test accessibility**
- 3. Accessibility responsibility did not automatically scale with the new team structure**

Four Steps Towards Shared Ownership

Start small, grow organically, and build shared ownership through existing product structures.



**Start with a
vision and
working group**



**Build domain
ownership**



**Embed
accessibility
into agile
workflows**



**Scale through
documentation
and design sys-
tems**

Creating a Place for Accessibility to Grow



- **Make accessibility visible and create a shared vision for ownership**
- **Bring together representatives from key domains**
- **Exchange, learn, align, and coordinate regularly**
- **Start small and grow organically**

Build Accessibility Expertise Within Each Domain

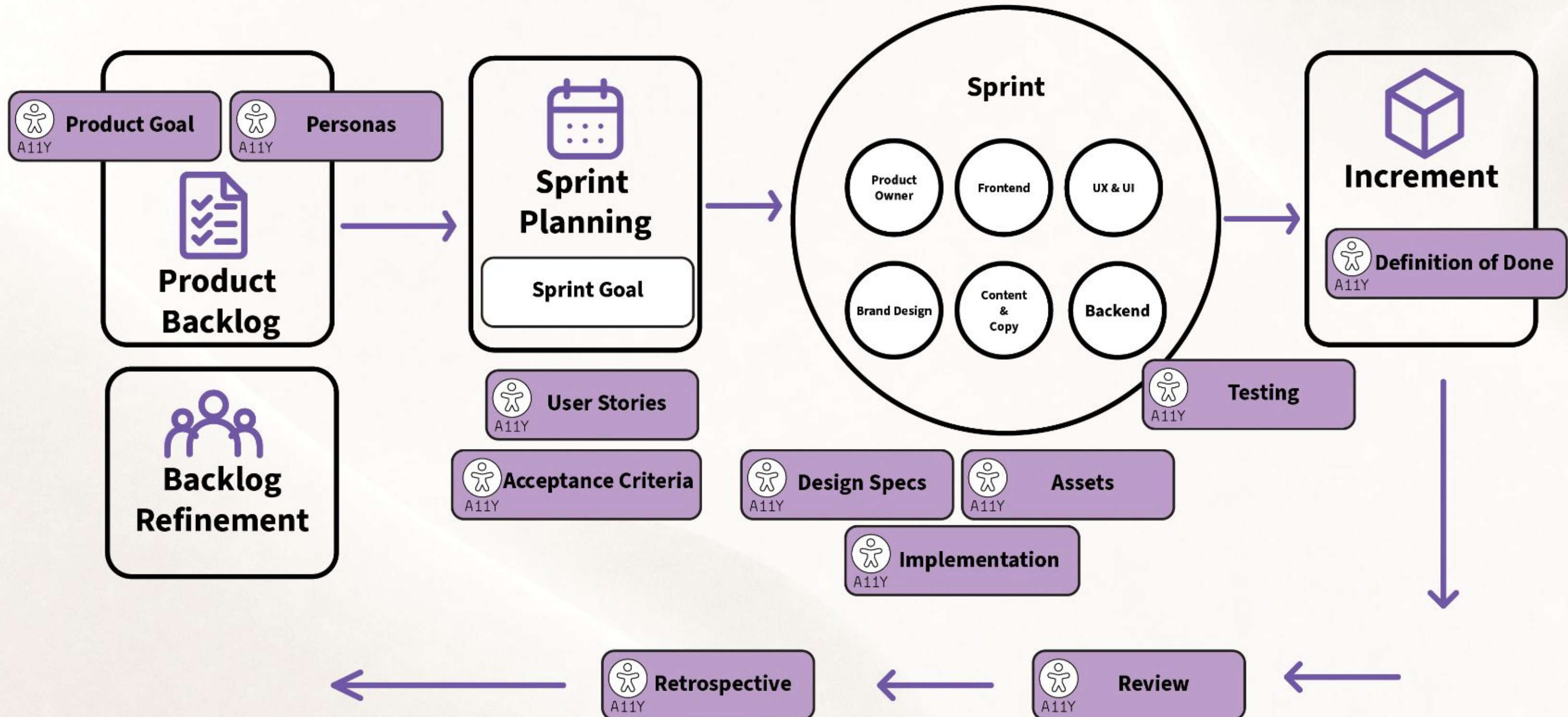
- Translate accessibility into domain-specific responsibilities
- Create practical resources, guidelines, checklists, and working agreements
- Grow ownership through concrete domain deliverables



How Each Domain Contributed

Domain	Deliverables
UX/UI & Brand Design	Accessibility in design principles, personas, and specs; contrast-safe color combinations and visual guidelines; annotations for hierarchy, states, focus, forms, and interaction behavior
Frontend & Backend	Accessibility in technical principles; semantic HTML, keyboard and screen reader support; shared testing methodology; accessibility checks in code review; support for accessible forms, CMS workflows, and automation
Content & Copy	Writing guidelines extended with accessibility and inclusivity guidance; inclusive language; guidance for headings, link text, and alt text; accessibility as part of editorial quality

Embed Accessibility Into Agile Workflows



Example: A Blog Article Teaser

“As a screen reader user, I want to browse blog article teasers and understand what each article is about, so that I can decide whether I want to open and read the full article”

Design with Purpose

Good design is more than aesthetics—it solves problems, creates clarity, and makes an impact.

Read the full article about [Design with Purpose →](#)



Example: A Blog Article Teaser

- **The teaser is marked up as a semantic article or content block**
- **The article title is exposed as a clear heading, for example an h2 in the page structure**
- **The article image has meaningful alternative text, or an empty alt="" if the image is decorative**
- **The link text clearly describes the destination, for example “Read: Designing with accessibility in mind”**
- **The link is usable with keyboard navigation**
- **Focus states are clearly visible**
- **etc.**

Using the Design System to Scale Accessibility

Image
Provide alt text

Eyebrow /
Category

DESIGN SYSTEM

Designing with accessibility
in mind H2

Learn how teams can build more inclusive
digital products from the start.

Read full article →

Descriptive
link text

Visible
focus state

Sufficient
contrast

Responsive
layout

Semantic structure

```
<article class="teaser">  
    
  
  <h2>  
    <a href="/blog/article-slug">  
      Designing with accessibility in mind  
    </a>  
  </h2>  
  
  <p>  
    Learn how teams can build more inclusive  
    digital products from the start.  
  </p>  
  
  <a class="teaser-link" href="/blog/article-slug">  
    Read full article
```

Documentation

Purpose

- Preview a blog article and link to the full post

Content

- Use a level 2 heading
- Provide meaningful alt text
- Use descriptive link text

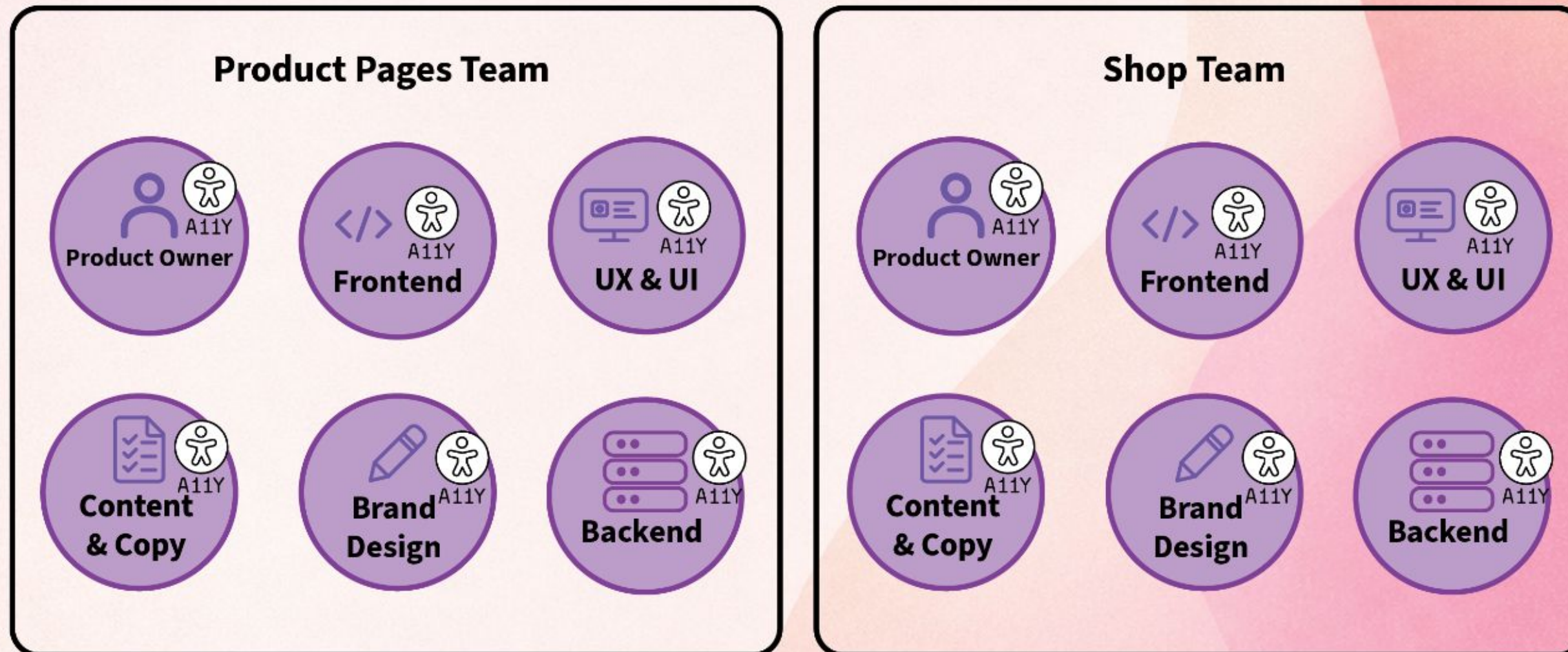
Accessibility

- Keyboard accessible
- Screen reader accessible
- Visible focus state
- Meets contrast requirements

Definition of Done

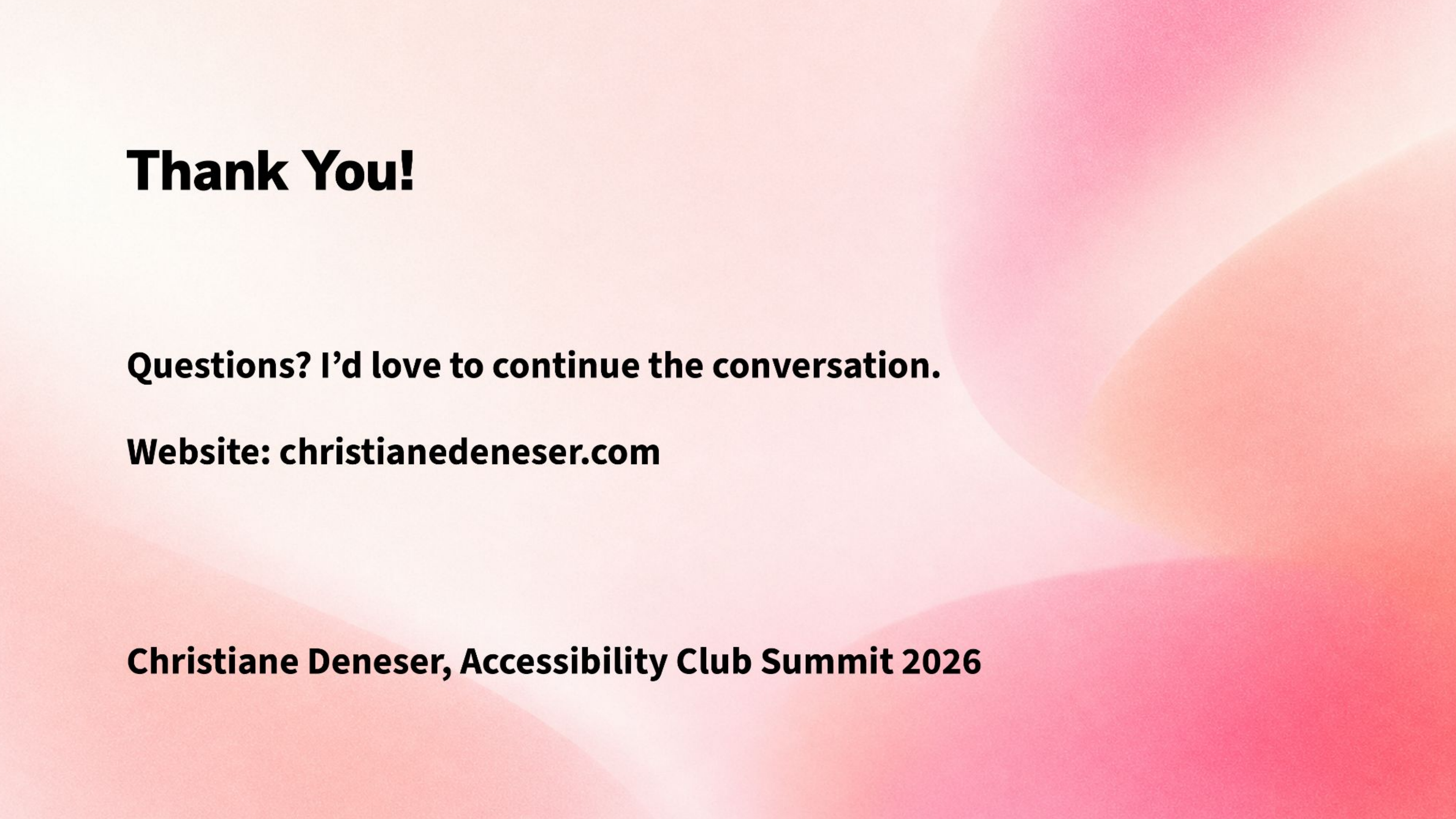
From Individual Responsibility to Shared Ownership

Cross-Functional Product Teams



Take Away!

- 1. Shared ownership needs structure**
- 2. Accessibility has to become specific to people's daily work**
- 3. Sustainable accessibility is a maturity process**



Thank You!

Questions? I'd love to continue the conversation.

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